Commonly used punctuation marks

1. Comma (,)

The comma is used to indicate a short pause. It is used:

a. for words, phrases and clauses in a series.

➢ For example,

Gandhiji, the Father of the Nation, died on 30th January, 1948.

b. when you address a person.

➢ For example,

"Yes, Sir."

c. to separate numbers, dates and address.

➢ For example,

I was born on 9th August, 1990 in Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh.

2. Semicolon (;)

The semicolon represents a stronger pause than a comma. It is used to stress the close relationship between one sentence and another.

➢ For example,

Today we love what tomorrow we hate; today we seek what tomorrow we shun; today we desire what tomorrow we fear.

3. Colon (:)

The colon is used to show that something is to follow.

➢ For example,

The principle parts of a verb in English are: the present tense, the past tense, and the past participle.

4. Full Stop (.)

The full stop is used to mark the end of a declarative or an imperative sentence. It represents the greatest pause.

➢ For example,

Abirami, Suganya and Sudha are best friends.

8th_english_7 to 8 .indd 221 16-12-2022 14:28:11